

**Special School Committee Meeting
Tuesday, November 24, 2020**

Via Zoom

Meeting Purpose: To discuss COVID 19 metrics to inform school decision making.

4:35 ROLL CALL: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7 present, 0 absent
Pledge of Allegiance

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent and Tom Milaschewski, co-presenting
Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Report on MPS Reopening
Guided by 3 pillars leading the work: Safety, equity and consistency
Oct. 14 SC Meeting, the SC approved the reopening dashboard:
3 parts

1. Building classroom readiness
2. Medford Community Health Metrics
3. District/School metrics

Since then, two things have changed:

1. Experience with COVID 19 response in schools
2. The state has changed the color coded metric chart

One thing that hasn't changed: the CDC, tells us that each indicator or combo of indicators should not be used in isolation or viewed as hard cut-offs by officials and school decision makers

Quoting Dr. Robert Redfield of the CDC,
"The truth is for kids K-12, one of the safest places they can be is in school."

I believe this holds true for Medford.

In our collaborative process, we developed the guidelines we have in place.

Showed a spreadsheet with COVID numbers in schools. Since September 9 in hybrid and 18 remote students have tested positive.

At this point in time I want to stress that we have noticed limited in-school transmission.

Tom Milaschewski:
Showing the DPH updated color coded metric.
Showed the dashboard approved on 10/14.
The color coding system is just one part of the decision making process.

Showing the new classification system:



Massachusetts Department of Public Health COVID-19 Dashboard - Friday, November 06, 2020
Average Daily Incidence Rate per 100,000 Color Calculations

Group	Population		
	Under 10K	10K-50K	Over 50K
Grey	Less than or equal to 10 total cases	Less than or equal to 10 total cases	Less than or equal to 15 total cases
Green	Less than or equal to 15 total cases	<10 avg cases/100k AND >10 total cases	<10 avg cases/100k AND >15 total cases
Yellow	Less than or equal to 25 total cases	≥10 avg cases/100k OR ≥5% pos rate	≥10 avg cases/100k OR ≥ 4% pos rate
Red	More than 25 total cases	≥10 avg cases/100k AND ≥5% pos rate	≥10 avg cases/100k AND ≥4% pos rate

As of 11/5, DPH is using 2019 population estimates derived from a method developed by the University of Massachusetts Donahue Institute. The 2019 estimates are the most currently available data.

27

As a team we have considered this DPH change as well as the CDC's guidance. Shows CDC Indicators and Thresholds of Risk. We look at the number of new cases and testing percentage positivity rate. Using the CDC guidance, we could have 19 cases and 4.5 % positivity and still be in the green. The DPH guidance is generally more Conservative than the CDC. Showing the old and new color coding chart.

Proposal tonight is to accept the DPH changes in the color coding system. Recommendation to keep section 1 and 3 and adjust section 2.

Questions about Tufts. How does Tufts impact the Medford numbers? Looking at a recent two week span, Tufts doesn't change the positivity number by much.

10.28-11.11	Tests	Positives	Positivity Rate
Medford per state data	15832	152	.96%
Tufts University, Medford	2520	4	.16%
Medford without Tufts	13312	148	1.11%

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Recommendations: Continue to use parts 1 and 3; update part 2 with DPH's new color coded classification chart. We are not looking to overhaul the original plan. We are asking that we accept the DPH adjusted color coded system.

Paul Ruseau: CDC standards are dependent on school and community mitigation strategies. DESE doesn't specify this so I believe the CDC is far more conservative.

I need to understand our contact tracing, testing and isolation protocols. I know the mayor is working to get the students tested. There is not a surveillance testing practice in our community. How much contact tracing can our staff do? CDC is clear that everything is dependent on mitigation.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Contact tracing is being done by Medford Public Schools. Acknowledging Toni Wray and Mary Ann O'Connor. This work happens all week long including weekends to get information out quickly. In the nine cases that have happened since September, the contact tracing was done effectively. Whether it is students or staff providing the information, the nurses respond and react appropriately. We have always prioritized safety. We have always mandated the quarantining. It has been manageable for the district at this point in time.

Paul Ruseau: I have a set of questions. I will do a few and let others speak. How many contact tracers do we have in the city and/or schools?

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: The contact tracing happens through the nursing staff in each respective building. Toni Wray assists with this.

Paul Ruseau: What is the software used to do this?

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Maven is the system the state requires us to use.

Mary Ann O'Connor: 3 nurses are on Maven. It happens in collaboration between the BOH and the schools. A lot of the time, these are self reported and then the immediate contact tracing happens in the school building. It is then communicated back to the Board of Health to be put into MAVEN.

Paul Ruseau: How does remote students contact tracing happen?

Mary Ann O'Connor: It happens through the Board of Health, not necessarily through the school nurse.

Paul Ruseau: How many cases can you trace before you run out of capacity?

Mary Ann O'Connor: they happen 24/7. We are onboarding five more contact tracers this week to keep up with the demand. It varies in the amount of time each case takes. Some people don't call back.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: What is the time frame of response? The state does provide backup in contact tracing help.

Mary Ann O'Connor: Many times it has been household transmission. The state picks up additional leads at 2 and 6 pm through their CTC.

Paul Ruseau: On the CDC website, there is a list of reports to evaluate the success of contact tracing efforts. Are we doing these reports? Does Maven handle these reports?

Mary Ann O'Connor: I can run reports out of Maven (open, closed cases, when put into Maven). Maven is limited as to what you can put in and get out. I follow up with the public health nurse on what is outstanding each day. Maven was not invented for COVID. It was invented many years ago so they are trying to update it to be more helpful for COVID but it has been limited.

Paul Ruseau: How do you know that contact tracing is happening for the students?

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I can only speak for the nine students that we have the data for (either reported to school or Board of Health). The school based nurses begin as soon as we are notified. Depending on the information about the individual about possible close contacts, appropriate steps are followed by the nurses.

Paul Ruseau: one of the slides in the slide deck. Covid 19 positive case count. All hybrid kids are also remote kids. Can this be adjusted for days in school and not in school? I find the nine total for hybrid. They don't show any scale. These numbers imply that twice as many kids are testing positive.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: 9 of the kids that have been in school have tested positive so far. Out of 1700 students who have come in either 4 days or 2 days a week, 9 students have tested positive in Medford. In that same time frame, 18 students in Cohort D have tested positive out of 1300 students who have officially selected the remote program.

Paul Ruseau: my question is, the 8th graders are the last group in. Are we talking about only the students who have been in the building?

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: they are students who have physically crossed the threshold of a MPS building.

Melanie McLaughlin: POINT OF INFORMATION: the nine have physically crossed the threshold. The 18 have not been in school.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: correct

Paulette Van der Kloot: going back to Mary Ann O'Connor. All together we have 27 students. When the contact tracers call them, do they always know where they traced it.

Mary Ann O'Connor: sometimes we know and sometimes we don't. In one case, both parents work remotely and the student is remote and they have no idea of knowing where they get it

aside from possibly grocery stores. Right now only 1 out of the 9 could possibly be considered that it could be school transmission.

Paulette Van der Kloot: How would you determine this?

Mary Ann O'Connor: One of the close contacts of a confirmed case later tested positive.

Jenny Graham: I am looking at the chart. It deserves definitions over what is remote and hybrid. Good that there was no transmission but we need to consider the dates of who was in school when. I want to know who is the category "remote students".

At MHS, does it mean a hybrid choosing high schooler tested positive or do we know that the positives were in Cohort A.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: Sounds like you are asking about a third column of students who have chosen hybrid but haven't gone to the buildings yet

Melanie McLaughlin: Point of Information: I think I am hearing, the denominator is helpful. 3 out of how many students in the building tested positive? A denominator or a percentage could clarify the information. MOC, could you share your background for people who don't know? What is your opinion on this reporting plan going forward.

Mary Ann O'Connor: I have been with the Board of Health in Medford for 4 years. I was for 12 years in Lynn BOH. Prior to that I was VP of a hospital system. I do believe we can sustain kids in school. We are not looking at any one particular metric to make a decision. You have to look at what is happening in the school or in the community. Clusters in long term care or at Tufts will raise our numbers but should not affect schools. We need to be nimble and look at the whole picture. Looking at the total picture, the plan is sound.

Kathy Kreatz: Thank you for the presentation. Special thanks to Toni and Mary Ann. I have been paying attention to DESE and the Governor and the Medford Board of Health and I trust the experts and health professionals saying kids should be in school. From everything presented, the spread is related to outings, family or community spread and not the schools. I would like to make a motion to accept the superintendent's recommendations to use parts one and three and then update part two to include the updated color coded classification system. Hearing from the experts, I have to put my trust in them and follow their guidance while monitoring the numbers.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Second it

Roll:

Jenny Graham: Not ready to do that

Melanie McLaughlin: Friendly amendment that data include the information we just spoke of to include the denominator and the third column we spoke of. Add a third column to include that data.

Jenny Graham: Not ready to vote just yet.

Melanie McLaughlin: amendment that the data be clarified as to what percentage of each population tested positive. Add the color code to the dashboard as well.

David Murphy: With regards to the data, it can be disaggregated potentially with regards to the cohorts as Members Graham and McLaughlin have asked for, but you might want to take in consideration, we can look back and figure it out. If they haven't come in yet, then they are not necessarily labeled cohort b or c if they are not in the building. As we go forward, that issue should diminish because as we move the 9-12 students back to the buildings it will be easier. Then there are no more pending to return students. But when a school or program has to go remote because of quarantine, it will be more difficult to disaggregate. It could change week to week. The counts could be misleading. The unintended consequence might be additional confusion rather than clarity.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Thank you Mr. Murphy. That was helpful.

Jenny Graham: I have several questions about the dashboard. What is the recommendation based on the colors when it comes to school closing.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: when I think about the original metrics, we have not moved away from the recommended scenarios. Once we hit a number, we would move to that particular position of moving a class remote. So far, we haven't had multiple cases in one particular building which is why we wanted to share the data at this particular time. If a particular school hits that number of metrics expressed in part 3, then we would make the recommendation to close a school. We have not had to do that at this time.

Jenny Graham: My question is about section two, Community Health Metrics, in the original plan, red means remote.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: The governor says that after 4 weeks in red, you can make the evaluation to go remote.

Jenny Graham: So red doesn't mean remote. Does red mean remote?

David Murphy: Nothing means instant move to remote. A totality of the circumstances analyzing the three prongs helps to make a decision. If we are deep into the red, we would not wait for four weeks to have a discussion. We need to look at it continuously. There is no single variable to make the district wide decision to move to remote.

Jenny Graham: I think it is important for the community to understand that the color status from the state does not mean that we automatically make a change to the school. Nothing about the color coding drives the decision automatically. I believe this language belongs on the document. It also needs to include the language explaining what happens when the district needs to make a decision. Also it needs to be clear, what needs to happen once we need to get to the point of making a decision? When we end up in red, does it mean the super. Will collaborate with boh and bring something to this committee? Or does this proposal say that you alone will make this decision?

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: All along we have been working as a team. We would definitely be communicating with the School Committee of a shift. It would be emergency communication or a phone call. I don't want the School Committee to feel they wouldn't be notified of a significant shift. We are closely looking at the data. If something like that were to happen, we would make a decision based on the data but include all stakeholders. The Governor may make that decision and we would immediately contact the School Committee and we would call an emergency meeting and communicate

Jenny Graham: I appreciate that "if the governor says..." then hands down. There is a difference between giving SC a heads up and asking the committee to collaborate on the best path forward. I want to understand, are you coming to the committee to make this decision with you? We will listen to the experts and have been doing so carefully and pragmatically. I think this decision has a wide impact on our community. The SC is here to give a voice to members of the community. If you are making a decision and just informing us, there is no collaboration and discussion. I am not saying that that is or isn't a good thing, I just want to be crystal clear about what you are asking us to do.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: If I may, we took a vote as a committee to give the administration, Ms Ray and the Board of Health the authority to make that decision.

Jenny Graham: You made that approval for staggered hybrid, not for the Superintendent to make that decision. That is not blanket authority going forward. What is this plan that you are looking to approve?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Member Van der Kloot, you have your hand raised?

Jenny Graham: I am actually not done and have more questions.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: I am confident in the ability of Ms. Wray, Ms. O'Connor and the administration to make this decision but I am sure that the Committee may have individual opinions.

Jenny Graham: What is the motion we are trying to approve right now?

Melanie McLaughlin: Point of information. There are a couple of things I want to ask. Are we getting any public participation on this call? I am trying to listen to all perspectives. We have a community member whose hand is raised. Mr. Murphy's hand is raised as well. I want to make sure we hear all perspectives.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I don't want this to be taken out of context. I would like to ask the entire School Committee to place their trust in me. As a parent and an educator of 25 years, I am not trying to put anyone's life at risk. I prioritize education. I am happy seeing students in school. At this point in time, we don't have the data support to shut down or operate differently. The data isn't there. The numbers are not showing it.

Paul Ruseau: point of personal privilege: At these meetings, School Committee members are being attacked for not wanting schools open. Saying we don't trust the Admin or the Board of Health. There is not a SC member in the entire nation who doesn't want kids in school. It is offensive.

Melanie McLaughlin: Point of Information; I disagree with Paul Ruseau. There has been a lot of emotion and it has been heated back and forth on all parts. This is not personal. We are all here to do the best for kids and the Superintendent has been leading that charge. This is the most difficult job anyone has been in. We cannot make this personal. No one is attacking anyone. We are all in this together and we are thinking of the children.

Paul Ruseau: Point of order: Points for personal privilege are not to be responded to. I want to reiterate that it is part of the rules.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Overruled.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I trust my judgment. If I had to call school, I would collaborate with my colleagues and work closely with Toni Wray and Mary Ann O'Connor. I would communicate early and clearly to the School Committee. I make that commitment to get the message across to members ahead of time. I would communicate early and clearly early to notify parents as soon as possible. Part of the responsibility of running a school district is to make the difficult decisions. It is what is expected of a superintendent and I am prepared to do that if that were to need to happen. I know that I can call and speak with any of you to discuss the issues but I am prepared to make these decisions.

Jenny Graham: I still have questions. I am happy to take turns but I do have questions.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: You do have the floor but Mr. Murphy, do you want to respond to Member Graham's questions.

David Murphy: Regarding Jenny Graham's question, in slide four, regarding the quote from CDC. We could take the language from that slide and insert it into our dashboard. As to the decision, we monitor this continuously. There have been instances where we had to decide to

transition a program to remote on short notice. It is not inconceivable that it might need to be made on a larger scale very quickly. For that reason, the superintendent needs to maintain the authority. This is on our agenda every meeting. The committee can convene and make this decision. Because it would take 48 hours, it is likely that the superintendent would need to act before that meeting. We are meeting every week or every other week and we are having this dialogue. That dialog is going to continue with the School Committee. The point is this is monitored on a daily basis.

Jenny Graham: We are sort of muddying section two and three. I still have questions. First I would like to look at Section 3. I don't want anyone on this call to think I have disagreed with any decisions so far. It is commendable that we have such low transmission. I don't want anyone on this call to think I have disagreed with any of these decisions to date. Your decision making is what I would have done myself. In section three, we did a lot of hard work collaboratively with community input to flush out these scenarios and they are working. What I ask is circling back to the intent of the language of section three. We need to outline in section 3, whether there are buildings where these situations are happening. Instead of the blurb that is there and not super meaningful week to week. They can look at this on a weekly basis for an update. I am asking to outline these decisions in section 3. Something that gives people who read the dashboard to know what is happening across the district. All I am asking is that we outline what is going on here. This might need to be a separate motion. I know what we intended to put in this section. I want the community to see these decisions as they have been made to keep school spread low. According to Section 3, the superintendent according to our rules has always had the authority to make these decisions and I don't recommend changing that. When we are making decisions based on section 2, what is happening community wide, this is out of scope of the Superintendent and the SC. That is where we are saying what is happening in our community is bad enough, then we need to make a decision on the schools. I think this decision needs to be collaborative. I would like to make an update to the language that red doesn't make a decision. We should remove the conclusion because it implies that the colors mean something. What people want to know who and how this decision should get made. For example if the governor says after four weeks in red, then we should be talking about an action, then that should be on this dashboard. At what point, should they expect action to make change? Back to the issue of who makes this decision, it is not solely about what happens in school, it is not solely making a decision on staff and transportation, we need to have a collaborative effort on this. We need to be clear about how we use the data. All I am asking is to have a collaborative conversation when the time comes. I am not asking to close schools; 4 people have contacted me that we were meeting to go remote. We need to be clear about how we will use the data and who will make the decision and that this committee tonight vote on how these decisions are made going forward? Does that make sense?

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I listened to what you are saying. As I hear about you speak about Section 2, we are looking at section 2 in isolation. If a decision has to be made on section 2 or 3, I still feel I should be able to make that decision with my team and communicate it to the School Committee. I still feel that it should be the same approach whether it is section one, two or three.

Melanie McLaughlin: Point of Information I don't know if people know what the sections are referring to:

Marice Edouard-Vincent

1. Building/classroom readiness
2. Medford Community conditions
3. District and school specific conditions

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: We have four residents. PVK do you want to go first?

Paulette Van der Kloot; I will speak after the community members speak. They have been waiting. Clarification: Member Graham, what precisely do you want as a resolution?

Jenny Graham: We never voted to change what is listed as Section 3. Cited section 3:

*Our top priority is to monitor the safety of our students and staff. **We will use the “[Medford Board of Health and MPS: Managing local COVID-19 conditions in our school buildings](#)” framework to guide our decision making** as we work with the Medford Board of Health to recommend plans and next steps as cases are identified. We will follow state issued guidelines in regards to notification, testing and quarantine protocols for COVID-19 positive persons and close contacts. Before a final decision is made on a school or district closure, the Superintendent must advise DESE and will communicate with the School Committee.*

The point of this document was to specify that this situation is occurring in my child's school. I am asking that a box be added to reflect classrooms, programs, grades where this decision has been made. (example, school A, classroom B - lets parents know if their child is affected). It gives the community information on what is being decided across the district. The current language is fine but I am asking for a box to be added to reflect which changes have been made. As the decisions are made, they should be listed.

Paulette Van der Kloot; To clarify, it would say a Brooks, grade 2 (made up example) sent remote? That is a hypothetical to be clear. My question is about confidentiality. If grade 2 is closed at whatever school, the parents would already know that their child's class was sent remote. What is the document accomplishing? You would see it across the district and I like that.

Jenny Graham; The value to see it across the district. It provides information for families and shows the community we are making good rational decisions about this stuff. I would rather us publish it rather than have it go out via the rumor mill which generates the calls we get. Being clear about this allows MPS to be the primary source of information.

Paulette Van der Kloot: So the box should say “current closures”. What closures do you have? Superintendent?

David Murphy: We do have a program that may need to go remote that would not be ideal to identify. I see the value of being transparent as it builds confidence in the community but I don't see the value in identifying a specific grade level. If a group has been transitioned to remote in a school, the people who need to know that information already have it. We can provide equally helpful information to the community that might not be as specific as grade level or program. We could have a tracking system to see what happened in a school. I can't tell you the age or how many students. I don't personally see the privacy in saying something happened at Brooks or at another building. Ms. O'Connor would know the Hipaa and Ferpa issues.

Mary Ann O'Connor: I agree wholeheartedly with Dave. We are hybrid now and the classes are very small. Naming a building is fine but going to class level/cohort is too specific.

Dave Murphy: There is one school community that is so small that it would have to be exempted from this reporting. With that exception I think it would be fine.

Jenny Graham: Maybe an asterisk saying we are not relaying information about that very small program due to confidentiality issues would be fine. I think that is a reasonable solution to providing the community at large some information.

David Murphy: The same rationale could be used for all programs in Cohort A. There is a higher level of privacy there. Some programs have very few students there. I am trying to think of a broader asterisk to protect privacy in smaller programs. Not cut and dry. Consensus from us we are not going to provide beyond school community level.

Mary Ann O'Connor: Building level.

Jenny Graham: That is reasonable.

Comments from the public:

Mr. Beagan: Congrats to the superintendent, staff, Toni Wray and Mary Ann O'Connor two months in and only one case of in school transmission. People are going to get COVID. As long as they don't pass it on to other students. My high schoolers cannot wait to get back. I trust our superintendent. I think this meeting should be cause for celebration.

Leticia Rocha: The principle is not about trust. The SC reflects the community voice. The cases are rising and to say nothing means remote is irresponsible.

Nadine Moretti: I believe we need to put our trust in the superintendent. The SC members don't necessarily speak for everybody. Great job so far getting up to the 8th graders in.

Mr. Christopher Carbone: It does appear from the data, that the safest place for children is to be in school. Schools are doing the best work. Inside a school is three times as safe as inside

a school. I completely agree with Mr. Beagan. This is a cause for celebration. Parents should be grateful to the Superintendent. They followed the protocols. Why are we treating this as anything but great news. Our Superintendent is clearly an improvement over our last superintendent.

Jessica: Reiterating what Mr. Carbone. My son is in Cohort A and was considered a close contact. I was notified right away. He stayed home for two weeks. Everything that needed to be done was done. What they needed to do, they did very quickly. I have full trust in the superintendent and her team. They know what they are doing. Let's give them that credit and let them do the work.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Some of the speakers made points I would like to make. One school transmission is good news. To the speaker who spoke about the role of the SC, we do. You have listened to me enough to trust my judgment. I have watched our Superintendent very carefully. I see them following them and working meticulously. I have no reason to question her judgment if we were facing a situation. I always feel kept in the loop by the superintendent. We do not need to be called into a special meeting to make this decision. We have selected her to follow our policies. I support the motion and do support the clarification that Jenny Graham made but only in the general sense. To make an analogy, the superintendent makes the call about snow days. She confers with experts and other superintendents. I know it is a simplification but it is relevant that she has the authority to make decisions. We are in a circumstance that calls on families to be flexible and nimble in the most difficult ways. I support leaving the decision with the Superintendent. This Superintendent has shown extraordinary dedication and has worked very closely with the School Committee.

Ms. Willard: I am glad to hear that the transmission is low. I was worried about kids going back and am glad it is low. I am concerned about the holidays. I know a lot of families and staff are planning to travel. I am wondering what the administration and nursing team is planning. I agree that the schools have been safe places but am concerned about the holiday and wonder if there is a plan for that.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: The city and schools have been communicating to families not to travel or celebrate in large groups. As of December 1 we will start testing once a week. It is not going to be mandatory but we will encourage it. It is not the invasive test. We need to finalize the details but we are hoping to start pool testing in January. We are working on funding partners right now and are taking every step testing wise and BOH and Admin wise to keep our kids in school in the safest way possible. Hopefully we will have news out this week regarding MHS but the plan will be coming soon. Please do the right thing over the holidays to keep transmission low.

Allison Leed: I have worked for ten years at the Broad Institute. I am happy to hear about the pooled testing. Wellesley High has been using pooled testing and used their results to shut down and prevented an outbreak. It was not mandatory in Wellesley either and it has been

working. I also would like to encourage use of the Alpha Med app. Question for the BOH, once testing is done, will this be taken into consideration with the metrics.

Mary Ann O'Connor: I am hoping we will get great participation. This is really going to help us in slowing the spread and catching outbreaks. We will need to look at the data aggregately and separately.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: We did send the form and encourage parents to fill out the form to make the testing as successful as possible.

Melanie McLaughlin: motion to move the question. Thank you to community members who came out to support the staff tonight. I did get a question about sanitizer in the school and whether the containers have alcohol in them or not.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent; We do have sanitizer. The lemon scented hand sanitizer is hospital grade. However based on the recent guidance, we made an additional investment of jugs with pumps of alcohol based sanitizer which was delivered to all of the buildings in the last two weeks.

Paul Ruseau; Reading emails:

Megan Bayer: Email encouraging students to stay in school. Commended Medford Public Schools for getting students into school. Community has done a lot for families at this time. Does not want to go backward.

Jim Donovan: I implore upon the school committee to make in person a top priority and give the administration the ability to make the decision.

Letisha Rocha: the positivity rate used for Tufts is not current. You should make this public in all of the dashboards. Admin have not made clear how is school administration defined?

David Murphy: I cannot stress enough the importance of getting the consent forms in. The testing is for all students who receive in person instruction. There is separate testing that will be done for students exhibiting symptoms. This is different from the surveillance testing that we are beginning soon. Remote students will not have access to this testing program.

Email from Mike Bergholzer, Lewis St: could you touch on the Tufts data again? Statistics seem like outliers.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent: I do not have the current data. I don't want to give misinformation.

Allison Leed: clarifying wording, there is confusion among parents about rapid testing.

Gary Klein, Sagamore Avenue: I appreciate the teachers working effectively. Has there testing for students? Absent a meaningful testing program, how do we know if it is spreading in the school. In light of rising numbers this number, it is fair to extrapolate that schools need to close. We need a plan in order to prepare for child care. We need more notice than New York City. We need to transition better than in march. Do we have plans for the high needs students? Does it make sense to bring more kids back as our numbers surge?

Paulette Van der Kloot; call the roll.

Jenny Graham: could someone read the motion

Melanie McLaughlin: Disaggregated data is the first addendum. Second addendum, information about what is happening in each building.

Kathy Kreatz: The broad information on each building?

Paulette Van der Kloot: Roll on the amendments (Lumping together?). Mayor: Yes
Amendments; 7 positive, affirmative paper passes

Roll on giving the superintendent with the help of Ms. Wray and Ms. O'Connor authority to make decisions on school.

Kathy Kreatz; Reading the Motion: to accept superintendent's recommendations, continue to use parts one (Building Readiness) and three (district and schools metrics) and update part two (Medford Community Health Metrics) of the Medford to include DPH's updated color classification system.

(Amendments from Melanie McLaughlin Include disaggregate data; Jenny Graham add asterisk to name which schools are affected)

Jenny Graham: Motion to sever.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Motion: Give superintendent and health team continued decision making authority on school closing and contact tracing ability.

Melanie McLaughlin: Didn't we already vote on that?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: We voted on doing that to allow for the staggered hybrid (as stated by Member Graham) so we should make it clear to make decisions on school closing and contact tracing ability.

Jenny Graham: I believe the issue we are voting on are the community health metrics driving closure. Can someone read the amendment?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: I am affirming the superintendent's ability to make decisions on classroom or school closures.

Jenny Graham: Based on sections 2 and 3?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: Based on collected information they have before them because there will be many variables and different situations.

Jenny Graham: I don't think anyone is posing questions about section 3. The superintendent is currently doing that and no one is making recommendations that she shouldn't be doing that. I believe the clarifications are solely on community health metrics driving closure.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Still giving authority to the superintendent.

Jenny Graham: For what

Paulette Van der Kloot: to determine whether schools need to close or should remain open

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: In determining whether classroom, school or district needs to close. We need to be clear on it. There is a motion on the floor and it was seconded and we need to take a roll call.

Jenny Graham: Who seconded? I am still not clear what we are saying. Classroom? Are we saying school based on section three but are we saying based on red, yellow, green? Our positivity rate etc. What are we saying?

Mayor Lungo-Koehn: It is all encompassing, based on our metrics, decision making of Board of Health. Affirming authority of superintendent.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Giving authority to the superintendent.

Paul Ruseau: I am sure what I am voting on either. Somebody has to write it into the minutes.

Dave Murphy: Recognized continued authority to make closures.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Yes

Dave Murphy: I think we have clarity on that

Paulette Van der Kloot: I don't think separating sections one and two make sense. I don't understand my colleagues lack of clarity on this. To me we are saying, the superintendent makes the final call. The school committee will not be called into session to take a vote.

Jenny Graham: There is a nuance. That is true today when it comes to classroom/program level closures. This committee should convene regarding community health metrics at a minimum so we can hear public commentary before we make a decision. I do not want to vote no on a blanket authority for the superintendent. I am uncomfortable where we have a situation where we go red for five or six weeks and no discussion is had by the committee.

Paulette Van der Kloot: We have meetings every two weeks so this couldn't happen. We talk about this at every meeting. You are trying to define something is not seeing the forest for the trees.

Jenny Graham: That is your opinion. I don't want to close schools. What I do want is a collaboration to make these decisions. I feel like part of the reason we have been so successful is we have started out in collaborative fashion. I do not feel comfortable putting it on the Superintendent's shoulders. The community will no longer be praising her. They will be calling for her head. All I am asking is before a decision is made we have a collaboration.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Motion on the floor so we can call the roll.

Jenny Graham: No Kathy Kreatz: Yes; Melanie McLaughlin: Yes; Mea Mustone: Yes; Paul Ruseau: no; Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes; Paulette Van der Kloot: yes
Five affirmative; two negative; paper passes

Original motion by Kathy Kreatz:

Roll call please: Jenny Graham: Yes Kathy Kreatz: Yes; Melanie McLaughlin: Yes; Mea Mustone: Yes; Paul Ruseau: Yes; Mayor Lungo-Koehn: yes; Paulette Van der Kloot: yes
7 affirmative; 0 negative; paper passes

Motion to adjourn: 7 affirmative - Happy Thanksgiving
6 affirmative; 1 absent (Paul Ruseau). Motion to adjourn passes.